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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2025
THIRD SEMESTER
DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC CORE COURSE (DSC) - MG3DSCTXL200 - TRADITIONAL DYED, PAINTED AND PRINTED TEXTILES OF INDIA
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Part A
Multiple Choice Questions
Answer all questions
Each question carries 1 marks

1. Tyrian purple is obtained from:
c). Sea snails

2. Choose the origin of the word 'Leheriya'.
a). Derived from the Sanskrit word "Lahara," meaning wave.

3. Name the Deity who is worshipped in the folk stories of Rajasthan.
a). Pabu

4. Label the technique used to create the distinctive patterns in Patola.
a). Double ikat

5. Identify the type of fabric used for Bandhani.
a). Cotton and Silk

6. Review the color on which Pabuji Ki Phad is traditionally rendered.
a). Red Fabric

7. Pochampalli sarees received GI status in which year?
b). 2005

8. In Batik printing, which step is carried out after the last dyeing to uncover the design?
a). Dewaxing

9. Match Ajrakh, the traditional textile art, with the list.
a). Block Printing

10. Name the material kept in the color tray that helps in smooth and consistent dye application.

a). Woolen Cloth (Kambli)
(In some reference, cotton too)

Part B

Fill in the Blanks
Answer all questions
Each question carries 1 marks

11. Alum/Myrobalan is a common mordant for natural dyes.

12. Patola was valued for its richness/Craftsmanship/exclusivity, because it was made of silk and, in addition, the weavers were of high caste.

13. The motifs in Mata ni Pachedi often depict mythological stories of Mother Godess.

14. In Pochampalli ikkat the yarn is dyed from light shades to darker ones.

15. The leheriya technique involves creating a diagonal wave pattern on the fabric.

16. The motifs/designs of the Machillipattinam resembles of Persian influence.

17. Kalamkari is originated in Andhra Pradesh.

18. Ajrakh/ Patola are known for its complex patterns & geometric designs.

19. The red outline color used in Bagru printing is known as kalijar.

20. From Indonesian language the term "Batik" originate.

Part C

Answer in One Word or One Sentance
Answer all questions
Each question carries 1 marks

21. Mention the common mordant for natural dyes.
A. Alum/ Myrobalan

22. State the common motifs used for Bandhakala.
A. Dotted patterns, Geometric patterns, Floral patterns, Paisley designs

23. Identify the art style that may have influenced Mata ni Pachedi's narrative compositions.
A. Kalamkari of Srikalahasthi

24. Identify the characteristic smell of Telia Rumal.
A. Oil smell

25. Name the patterns used in Bandhej techniques.
A. Bhujkia: dot patterns
Gharchola: checks or grid patterns
Chandrakhani: moon-shaped patterns
Amarpatti: floral and foliage patterns

26. Identify the primary medium used in Rogan painting.
A. Castor oil

27. Identify the local term for the Rogan painting stylus.
A. Kalam/ Kalamdam

28. Name any three motifs used in Bagru printing.
A. Some common motifs used in Bagru printing include, Floral patterns, Geometric shapes, Birds and animals

29. Name two floral motifs used in Sanganeri prints.
A. Sanganeri Prints Motifs include Floral sprays, Champa and other flowers motifs like gulabi (rose) chameli (jasmine), etc., are also common.

30. Explain the function of sawdust in traditional Dabu printing.
A. Sawdust in Dabu Printing: Absorb excess paste or dye & Prevent colors from spreading or smudging.

Part D

Short Answers

Answer any 5 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

31. List out any four common natural dyes and their colour.
A. Natural Dyes and Colors
1. Indigo - Blue
2. Turmeric - Yellow
3. Madder root - Red/Pink
4. Pomegranate rind - Brown/Corals
5. Iron - Grey

32. Summarize about Pabuji Par.
A. Pabuji Par, also known as Pabuji Ki Phad, is an integral part of Rajasthan's rich cultural and artistic heritage. It is a traditional Rajasthani scroll painting that depicts the life and adventures of Pabuji, a folk deity. These intricate paintings are used as a visual accompaniment to oral storytelling and performances, where the Bhopas (priests and narrators) unfold the scrolls to narrate the epic tale of Pabuji, that is painted on cotton using natural colors.

33. Explain how fabric quality and design intricacy affect the price of Bandhani textiles.
A.1. Design Intricacy & Tie complexity: More intricate tie patterns require skilled artisans and more time.
2. Design details & Craftsmanship: More intricate designs require greater skill and time. Also Skilled artisans' expertise and time contribute to the final price.
3. Fabric Quality: High-quality fabrics like silk or fine cotton increase the price.

34. Explain the role of hand painting in enriching Mata ni Pachedi designs.
A. Hand painting plays a significant role in enriching Mata ni Pachedi, by showing the artisans skills in adding fine details to the designs, making them more vibrant and expressive. Each hand-painted piece is distinct, reflecting the artisan's skill and creativity. The combination of traditional techniques and artistic hand painting skill makes Mata ni Pachedi a unique and valuable form of folk art.

35. Mention the historical value of Calico fabrics.
A. Calico’s origins can be dated to the 11th century, in some reference, but gained popularity in 16th century and traced to a tiny weaving community in Kerala called the Saliyas. As early as 1630, cotton calico prints were being exported to England where they were praised for their beautiful patterns. During the 1700s, England banned the import of calico in order to strengthen its own fabric industry. Although the move initially failed due to calico being especially popular amongst women known as 'Calico Madams,' the Calico Act eventually caused India to lose its textile industry. This devastation forced India to import directly from England.

36. List the three characteristics that Batik is known for?
A.1. Wax-resist dyeing: The use of wax to resist dye and create unique patterns on fabric.
2. Intricate designs: Batik is characterized by intricate and detailed designs, often featuring floral patterns, geometric shapes, and other motifs.
3. Hand-painted or stamped patterns: Batik can be created using either hand-painted or stamped techniques, allowing for a range of creative expressions.

Part E

Long Answers

Answer <u>any 2</u> questions

Each question carries 5 marks

37. Explain fabric painting techniques.
A. Traditional Fabric Painting Techniques
Painting is the technique of fixing colour to a woven cloth, to create patterns applied with a pen, brush, metal or wooden block or through a stencil. The painting or printing of mordants on to cloth which, when immersed in a colour bath, will cause the dyes to react and be fixed by the patterns of applied mordant.
Hand painting: Directly painting designs onto fabric using brushes or specified tools like stylus pen. Some traditional fabric painting techniques include Kalamkari, Pabuji Par, Mata ni pachedi. These

techniques require great skill and craftsmanship, resulting in unique and beautiful textiles.

38. Explain the complete process of yarn preparation, dyeing, and weaving in Telia Rumal.
A. Process
The preparation of the yarn is an important component towards delivering a great product. Traditionally, the yarn is treated with oils of sesame and castor seed, along with sheep dung. This process took 21 days. The process makes the yarn completely saturated and soft. These yarns make different oily smell due to use of oil in yarn treatment which leads to terming of this square rumal as Telia Rumal.
The treated yarn which is used for the warp (length) and weft (width) is tied and dyed in accordance with a predetermined geometrical design.
Pre Treatment:
The yarn is steeped for 24 hrs in the solution prepared with sheep/cow dung. Then, foreign matter is removed by twitching the yarn. Apart, castor-seed shells are burnt to get ash which is further mixed with gingerly oil, to get thick solution. The yarn treated with dung solution, is now soaked in the above solution in small quantities and worked for about15 min, squeezed and sun-dried. Thereafter, the whole process is repeated , in sun, for 16 days, before washing and drying. Now, the yarn is ready for preparation of warp and weft.
Ikat Process:
Double-Ikat technique is adopted for manufacturing telia rumal. The craft involves a complex double ikat weaving process where both the warp and weft threads are resist-dyed before weaving. Marking on warp and weft yarn is done on the frames which are based on number of repeat patterns. Accordingly warp and weft yarns are grouped and then folded, before tying proceeds.
Tying with cotton or rubber strings for resisting the area is done .Tied yarn is then dyed in a dye-bath prepared with Alum (used as mordant) and Alizarin, in equal quantities for 2-3 hrs at hot water, steeped for 12 hrs, so as to get red colour.
The yarn is then squeezed uniformly, washed next day and dried. Likewise, the yarn is again tied with rubber strips as per design and treated in solution prepared with Alizarin, to get black colour.
Weaving a telia rumal needs a great amount of practice and perfection for the warp and weft to be meticulously converted to an artistic design. The number of motifs makes it more complex and difficult to weave.

39. Quote the steps & process involved in the making of Kalamkari fabric.
A. Kalamkari work is a time-consuming process, involving as many as 15 to 24 steps, varying with the adaptations. This includes bleaching, the application of myrobalam, painting and printing, washing, dyeing, bleaching, starching, waxing, indigo vat dyeing, wax removing, bleaching, starching, the application of yellow and green colors, the application of alum and bleaching.
Details of the process of Kalamkari both in Srikalahasti and Machilipatnam styles:
Materials
Kalam - a pen made of bamboo reed, a cotton cloth rolled over the reed and tangled by the cotton thread. Two different kalams are required, one for outlining and one for colour filling.
Cotton cloth for fabric printing, traditionally called gaada
Buffalo milk to treat the cloth and avoid colour spreading
Alum is the mordant (dye fixative) used in the dying process to ensure the stability of colours.
Various handmade dyes
Myrobalan (Karaka/ Harad locally & Thannikka/ Kadukka in malayalam) and Myrobalan flower (Karakapinde locally & Thaannippoovu in Malayalam) for enhancing the dyes and making them permanent.
Tamarind stems are burnt into charcoal as pencils for initial sketching.
Jaggery
Water

1. Preparation of Cloth: A cotton cloth is steeped in water overnight to remove impurities and then dried under the sun. After this, the cloth is treated in the solution, grinded with Myrobalan bud, flower paste, and buffalo milk. After immersing in milk solution for few minutes, the cloth is taken out and squeezed to remove the excess solution, and it is allowed to dry under the sun for few hours. The cloth is washed in running water three times and dried under the sun to get a uniform off-white colour and smooth texture.
2. Outlining and Sketching: The initial sketching on the processed cloth uses charcoal pencils made using burnt tamarind branches. The detailing uses a pencil, and the kalam is dipped in Kasim Kaaram to trace the design. Kasim Kaaram is an iron black colour solution prepared using rusted iron filings, cane jaggery and palm jaggery. These materials are dissolved in water in a closed earthen pot for fermentation. After that, the solution is filtered, and the iron filings are removed. The dye colour contacts the cloth when the artisan squeezes the cotton ball of kalam slightly. This black colour turns darker when it reacts with Myrobalan-treated cloth. The excess outline colour is removed using a soft cloth by pressing it gently on the design. The cloth is washed again.
3. Red Color Development: The red colour is obtained by mordanting the cloth with alum. The painted alum cloth is allowed to dry for few days and then washed under running water. The painted cloth is immersed in the solution and boiled at a high temperature. These
tree roots lend red colours. Once the red colour appears, the fabric is washed repeatedly. During this process, the coloured areas remain the same, and the rest of the fabric is whitened.
4. Filling Colors: Red-coloured cloth is now taken to the colour-filling process. The yellow colour obtained using pomegranate skin is initially filled in the required portions. Then it is followed by green (obtained by mixing myrobalan flower, Kasim karam and alum mixed with water). Finally, the blue colour made with indigo leaves is filled. The colour filling is done using tapered-edged kalam.

40. Explain how Dabu printing contributes to environmental sustainability.
1. Natural dyes: Dabu printing uses natural dyes derived from plants, which are biodegradable and non-toxic.
2. Low water usage: The printing process requires minimal water, reducing the environmental impact.
3. Handcrafted: Dabu printing is a traditional, handcrafted technique that promotes sustainable and eco-friendly practices.
4. Local and organic materials: The use of local and organic materials in Dabu printing supports sustainable agriculture.
By adopting traditional and eco-friendly practices, Dabu printing helps promote environmental sustainability in the textile industry.

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